



RIGHTSIZE. RIGHT SUPPORT. **RIGHT** *for* **STUDENTS.**

A family guide to the proposed school changes

Every school is a community. A school change can affect friendships, routines, programs, and a family's sense of belonging. This guide explains what is proposed and why.

Scenarios A and B are proposals, not final decisions. "No changes proposed" means these options do not include a change for that school.

Each school has a snapshot and a box explaining the reasons for the proposal. The next page shows enrollment estimates, programs, student groups, and maps. Estimates cover 2027-28 through 2031-32. They are not current student counts.

The possible benefits are goals. A larger school does not automatically get a full-time librarian, certain staff, or specific programs. Those details depend on the district's staffing rules, budget, and plans for making the changes.

A school or program move does not determine where an individual student receiving special education services will go. Families and school teams would need to plan each student's services and support.

The school details, numbers, and maps come from PPS school profiles. This guide explains that information in simpler language.

Words you may see in this guide

No changes

What is expected if the district keeps the current schools and programs.

Option A / Option B

The two scenarios. "A and B" means the same information applies to both.

School boundary

The area used to assign students to a neighborhood school based on where they live.

School communities joining

Students from two or more schools would come together. The proposal says which school building would close.

Programs joining

A program would come together at one school or move to another school.

DLI

Dual Language Immersion: learning in English and another language.

School size goal

More than 360 students for K-5 schools; more than 500 for K-8 or middle schools; more than 1,100 for high schools. These are planning goals, not ratings of school quality.

Space use goal

The district aims to use 70%-100% of a school's available room for students. A "No" can mean the school is below or above that range.

Title I

Federal money that supports schools serving students from low-income households. The guide shows the expected designation.

IEP

An Individualized Education Program: a written plan for a student's special education services and support.

Choice program

A program with a special focus, such as arts or science. It may serve families beyond a neighborhood school boundary.

Student groups

Groups can overlap. Do not add the percentages together.

**You may notice slight differences in student numbers and/or demographics in schools that don't experience change because a focus option school has changed and we assume that students return to their neighborhood school.*

BRIDGER CREATIVE SCIENCE

School proposal | Options A and B

SCHOOL SNAPSHOT	DETAILS
Current program	K-8 neighborhood & choice program
Expected enrollment with no changes	450 in 2027-28; 415 in 2031-32
District school size goal	More than 500 students (general district goal)
Students living within 1 mile	97.9%
Building notes	None

WHY IS PPS CONSIDERING THIS?

Steady student numbers: Changing to K-5 boosts middle school enrollment in neighborhood schools while protecting its unique learning program.

This is a proposal, not a final decision.

What is being proposed?

Bridger Creative Science would change from a K-8 to a K-5 school.
The school would keep both its neighborhood school area and its Creative Science special-focus choice program.
Current middle grade (6th and 7th) students would be reassigned to Harrison Park Middle School or could choose to return to their neighborhood middle school.

What could students gain?

Focused early childhood school: Elementary students benefit from a school and playground designed for younger children. Richer middle school options: 6th-8th grade students gain access to broader middle school electives and learning options at a comprehensive middle school.

What else was considered?

Preserving student enrollment: Keeping both the neighborhood area and the special-focus choice program protects student enrollment and honors the school's unique community history. Southeast Guiding Coalition: Because of many recent changes, the decision was made to preserve the special-focus choice portion of Bridger Creative Science to ensure steady support after many other changes.

BRIDGER CREATIVE SCIENCE

ENROLLMENT, PROGRAMS & MAPS

How many students are expected?

School year	2027-28	2028-29	2029-30	2030-31	2031-32
No changes	450	444	440	421	415
Options A and B	310	304	313	313	305

Programs, school size & nearby families

Measure	No changes	Options A and B
Type of change	No changes	Grade changes
Meets school size goal?	No	No
Meets space use goal?	Yes	No
Students living within 1 mile	97.9%	98.1%
Grades and programs	K-8 neighborhood & choice program	K-5 neighborhood & choice program

Where would the school boundary be?



Who would the school serve?

Option	Poverty	Special education	Multilingual services	Underserved racial groups	Title I
No changes	27.1%	21.7%	4.3%	20.9%	No
Options A and B	23.9%	20.4%	3.5%	18.5%	No